Workplace Memorandum

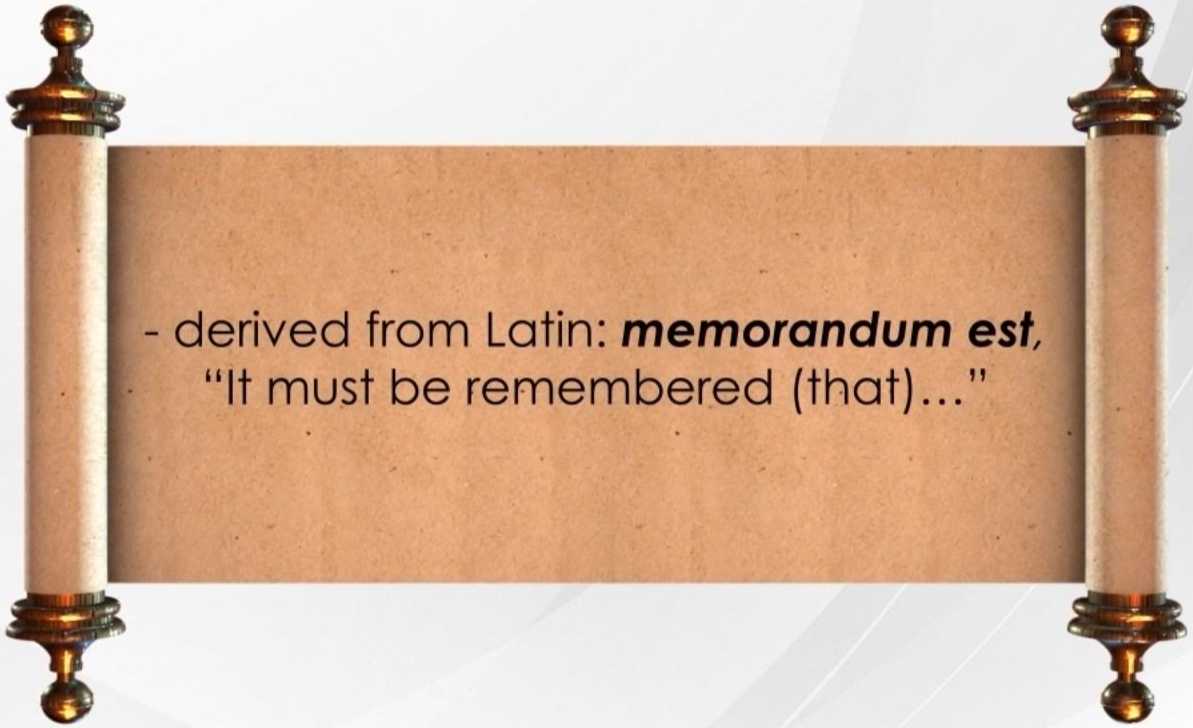
Prepared by:
Vanrom Kip P. Follosco

MEMORANDUM



- a short message or record used for internal communication in a business

(How to Compose a Memo, 2020)


- derived from Latin: ***memorandum est,***
"It must be remembered (that)…"

Internal Audience



External Audience





Know your PURPOSE

- To inform the audience?
- To persuade people to support a new plan?
- To motivate them to take action?
- To announce bad news?

MEMO vs EMAIL

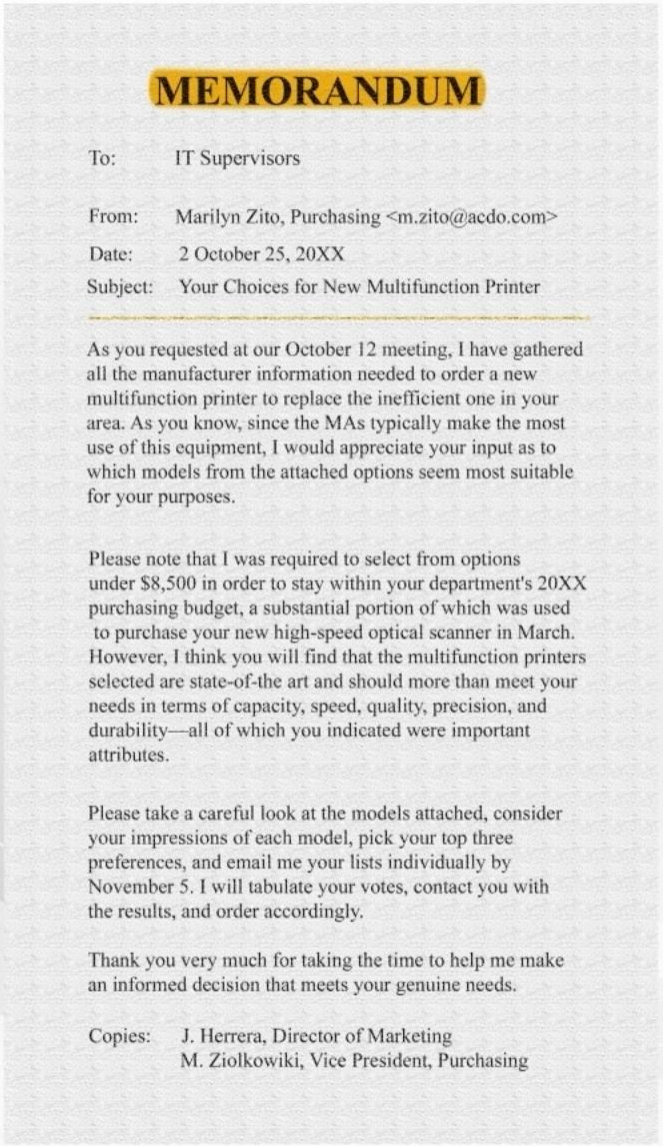


- emails are less formal than memos
- emails can function as memos
- emails may be ignored in a crowded inbox

The Standard Parts of a Memorandum

STANDARD MEMO PARTS & FORMAT

- word **MEMO** or **MEMORANDUM**
- **Heading** [Recipient, Sender (and sender's initials), Date, Subject]
- **Body**
- **Distribution Notation**



MEMORANDUM

To: IT Supervisors

From: Marilyn Zito, Purchasing <m.zito@acdo.com>

Date: 2 October 25, 20XX

Subject: Your Choices for New Multifunction Printer

As you requested at our October 12 meeting, I have gathered all the manufacturer information needed to order a new multifunction printer to replace the inefficient one in your area. As you know, since the MAs typically make the most use of this equipment, I would appreciate your input as to which models from the attached options seem most suitable for your purposes.

Please note that I was required to select from options under $8,500 in order to stay within your department's 20XX purchasing budget, a substantial portion of which was used to purchase your new high-speed optical scanner in March. However, I think you will find that the multifunction printers selected are state-of-the art and should more than meet your needs in terms of capacity, speed, quality, precision, and durability—all of which you indicated were important attributes.

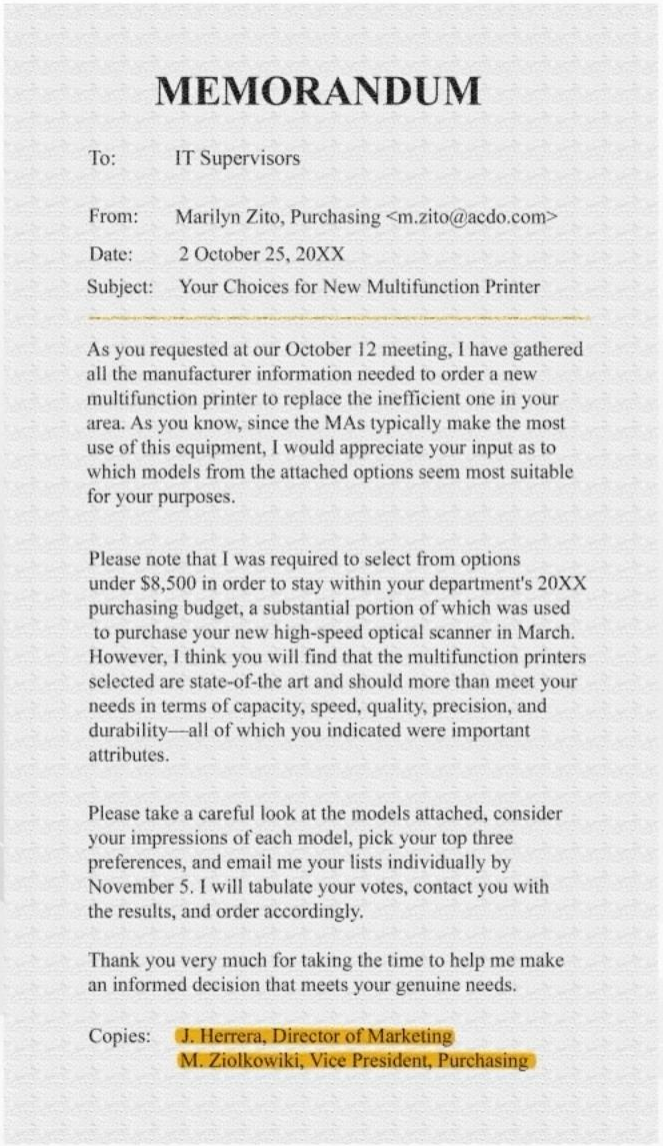
Please take a careful look at the models attached, consider your impressions of each model, pick your top three preferences, and email me your lists individually by November 5. I will tabulate your votes, contact you with the results, and order accordingly.

Thank you very much for taking the time to help me make an informed decision that meets your genuine needs.

Copies: J. Herrera, Director of Marketing
M. Ziolkowiki, Vice President, Purchasing

1. MEMO or MEMORANDUM

centered at the top of the page or flush to the left margin



MEMORANDUM

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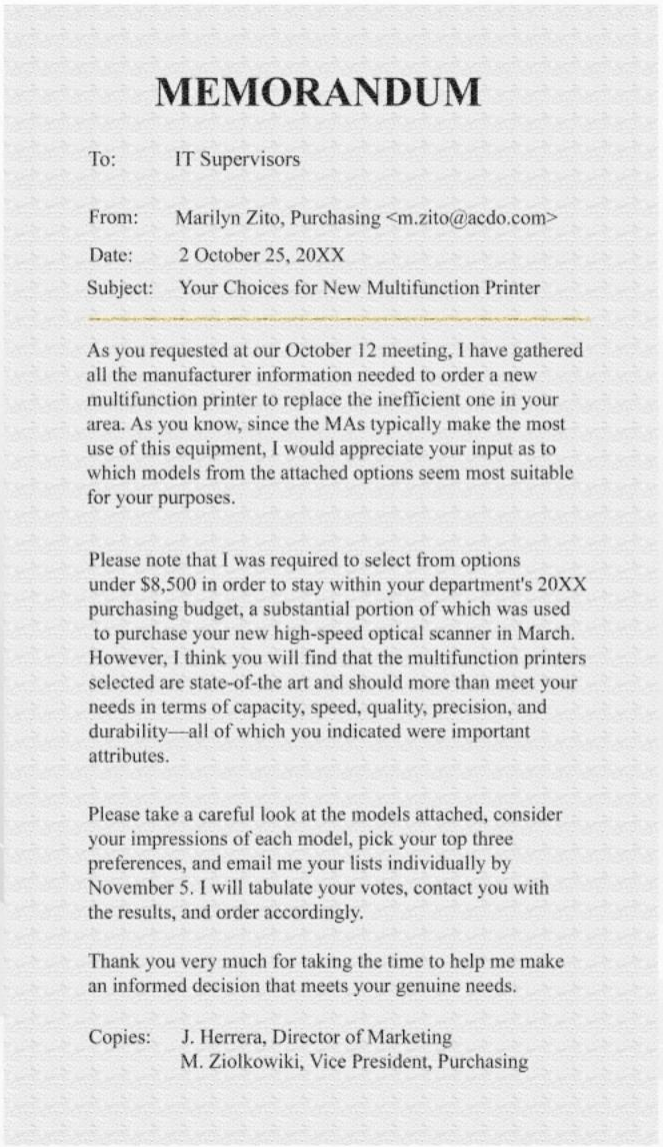
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2. HEADING

TO line – key all names in one line or in a list

Distribution List



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M. Ziolkowiki, Vice President, Purchasing

Ordering Names

Hierarchical and Alphabetical

Jane Vega (Sales Manager)
John Cruz (Asst. Sales Manager)
Rose Mesa (Sales Associate)

2. HEADING

MEMO

To: Jane Vega, John Cruz, Rose Mesa

From: **Vanrom Kip Follosco**


Why do we need to initial or sign our memos?

2. HEADING

DATELINE

Traditional – May 1, 2023

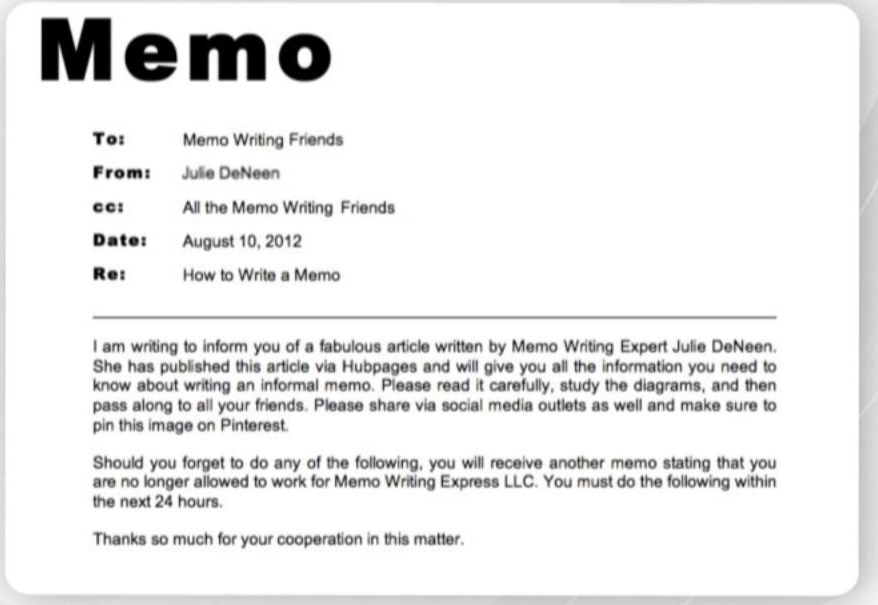
International – 1 May 2023

MM/DD/YYYY or DD/MM/YY

6/11/23



2. HEADING
SUBJECT



Memo

To: Memo Writing Friends

From: Julie DeNeen

cc: All the Memo Writing Friends

Date: August 10, 2012

Re: How to Write a Memo

I am writing to inform you of a fabulous article written by Memo Writing Expert Julie DeNeen. She has published this article via Hubpages and will give you all the information you need to know about writing an informal memo. Please read it carefully, study the diagrams, and then pass along to all your friends. Please share via social media outlets as well and make sure to pin this image on Pinterest.

Should you forget to do any of the following, you will receive another memo stating that you are no longer allowed to work for Memo Writing Express LLC. You must do the following within the next 24 hours.

Thanks so much for your cooperation in this matter.

2. HEADING
SUBJECT



Re/re – used to introduce a reference in an official letter



A memo should cover only one main point.


Subject: 1. Vacation and Sick Leave Slips
2. Death of Mr. Martin's Mother-in-law

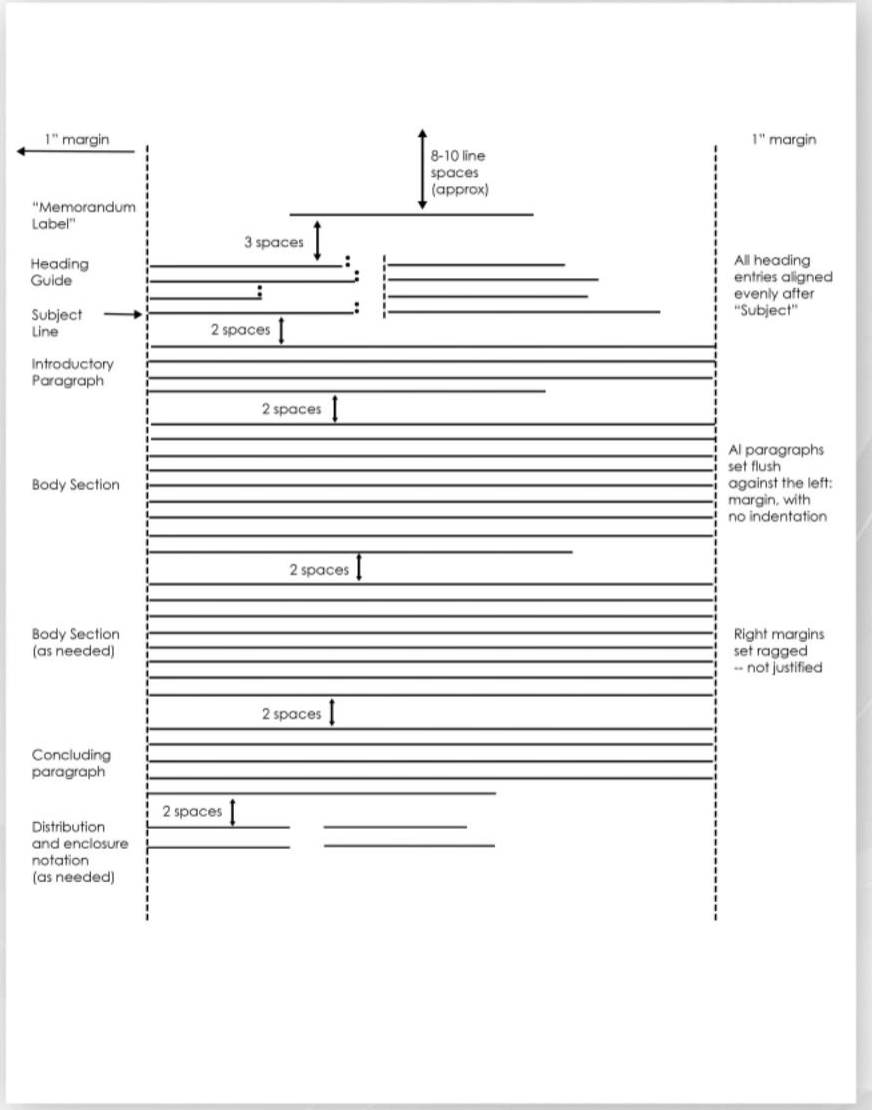
3. BODY

- focuses on one topic
- has an introduction, the main issue, and other supporting statements

4. DISTRIBUTION NOTATION



4. DISTRIBUTION NOTATION



STRIVE FOR A BALANCED LOOK!

Approaches in Writing Memos and Other Guidelines

Approaches in Writing Memos

DIRECT APPROACH

- begins with the “bottom line” and presents the details or analysis to support your case

MEMO
To: All employees
From: Meredith Rocteau, Payroll Manager MR
Date: May 19, 20XX
Subject: Delay in Paychecks

I regret to inform you that those employees paid by direct deposit will experience a two-day delay in receiving their paychecks.

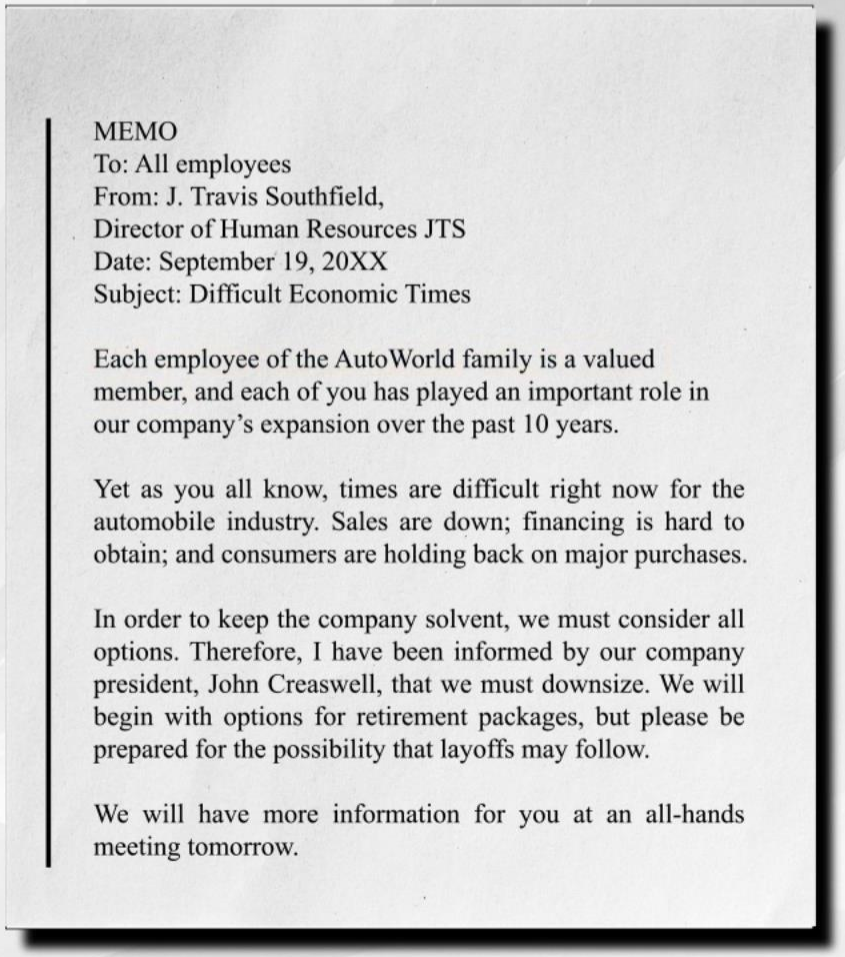
This delay is due to a virus that infiltrated the primary computer server for our payroll system. Although we hired virus consultants to identify the virus and clean out the server, the process took nearly 48 hours.

We apologize for the inconvenience.

Approaches in Writing Memos

INDIRECT APPROACH

- lays out the details of the case over several sentences before delivering the “bottom line” later in the paragraph



MEMO
To: All employees
From: J. Travis Southfield,
Director of Human Resources JTS
Date: September 19, 20XX
Subject: Difficult Economic Times

Each employee of the AutoWorld family is a valued member, and each of you has played an important role in our company’s expansion over the past 10 years.

Yet as you all know, times are difficult right now for the automobile industry. Sales are down; financing is hard to obtain; and consumers are holding back on major purchases.

In order to keep the company solvent, we must consider all options. Therefore, I have been informed by our company president, John Creaswell, that we must downsize. We will begin with options for retirement packages, but please be prepared for the possibility that layoffs may follow.

We will have more information for you at an all-hands meeting tomorrow.

Why do we need to have a **consistent** and **predictable** format for memos?

Common Types of Memos

Transmittal Memo

- accompanies a package of materials
- provides a paper trail
- gives an overview of the sets of documents

Greentree
Bionomics Inc.

MEMORANDUM

To: D. Spring, Director of Human Resources
From: M. Noll, Head, Biology Division. MN
Date: January 16, 20XX
Subject: Hiring of New Laboratory Manager

As you know, each unit manager has been asked to prepare a hiring plan for the coming year. Attached to this memo please find a brief report justifying the biology division's need for a new laboratory manager.

The attached report includes
- an overview of needs
- a job description
- a budget

Please let me know if you require any additional information. I look forward to hearing from you.

Enclosure: Justification report

Common Types of Memos

Summary / Follow-up Memo

- provides a written record of a meeting, conversation, or topic discussed

Incredible Software and Graphics Inc.

Memo

To: Elaine Lamer and Mitchell Dramson, Software Development Team
From: Christopher Felts, Manager CF
Date: June 19, 20XX
Subject: Follow-Up to Today's Meeting

Thank you for meeting today to discuss next steps to complete the updated version of our animation software page.

As you noted, the original release date of October 1 is probably too optimistic given the latest hiring freeze. Yet, as I mentioned, we can't afford to go beyond a date of October 15, if we hope to make our fourth quarter sales goals. So, let's agree of October 15 as the new due date.

Please communicate this information to the other members of your team.

cc: E. Hearly Division Chief

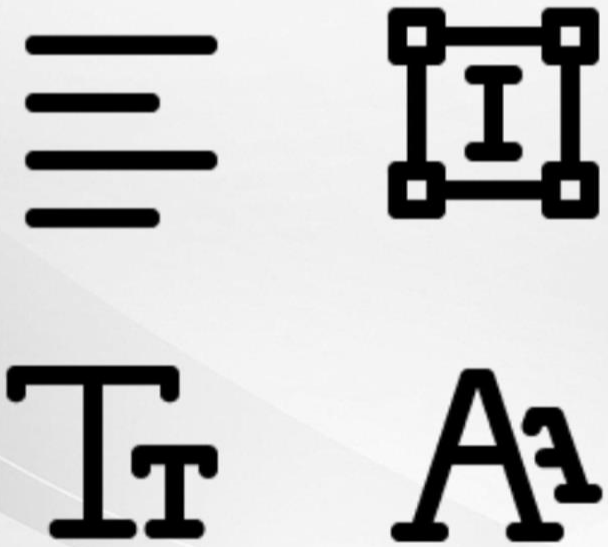
Common Types of Memos

Routine Miscellaneous Memo

- covers a variety of topics

Anything that is not a summary or a transmittal memo may be classified as a routine miscellaneous memorandum.

Guidelines in Memo Writing

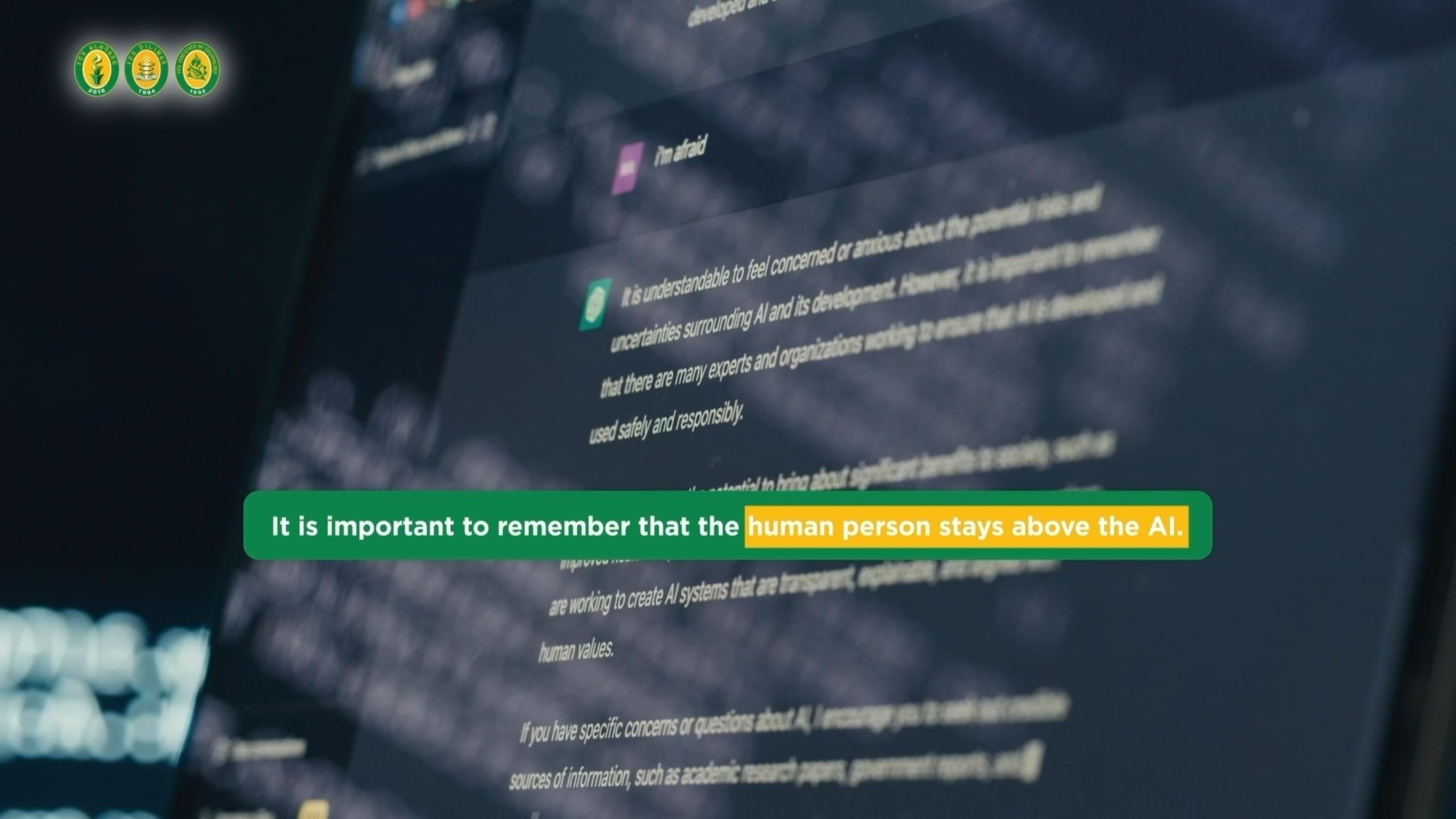


- Do not overuse or misuse memos.
- Use memos for in-house purposes only.
- Focus on one topic.
- Be brief.
- Maintain a polite tone.
- Avoid sounding too formal or informal.
- Follow the advised standard format.

Guidelines in Memo Writing



- Use white space, headings, and bullets.
- Use tables, charts, and other visuals.
- Check spelling, grammar, and style.
- Initial or sign your memos.
- Decide on the medium.



It is important to remember that the human person stays above the AI.

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How to Compose a Memo. (2020, February 5). ThoughtCo. https://www.thoughtco.com/memorandum-memo-term-1691377

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